

SUMMARY KEYWORDS

choir, singers, join, rehearsals, male voice

choir, caroline, work, people, opera, town, singing, fairly competent, white, vocal coach, john, average attendance, friends, elizabeth, companies, attend

SPEAKERS

Speaker 2 (85%), Speaker 1 (15%)

1

Speaker 1

0:00

Now turn to section two. Section two, you will hear a radio program about singing in a choir. First, you have some time to look at questions 11 to 15. Now listen carefully and answer questions 11 to 15. And for our regular spot on things to do in town, here's our reporter Samuel Cooper. It's been fun to write about joining some of our local choirs.

2

Speaker 2

0:30

Thank you, well, feeling a bit apprehensive about my ability to sing in tune. I recently headed off for rehearsals at the town's three biggest choirs mitchelstown Choir, the Black Bell male voice choir and the Caroline singers. I received a very warm welcome at all three choirs. They are always on the lookout for new and enthusiastic singers. Now, obviously deciding which choir to join will depend to some extent on your taste in music. Blackbell caters for most musical tastes as it has a hugely varied repertoire as does mitchelstown. If you're after a more classical feel that Caroline singers tend to focus on madrigals. That's unaccompanied singing without any instruments. If you want to meet people who share an interest in music mitchelstown Choir is a good place to start. Apart from their own performances. They also arrange group visits to see operas and attend music festivals. So it can be a great way to make friends. But it's not just a chance to develop a skill traveler make friends that's on offer. You could win a gold medal to mitchelstown are hoping to get to the final at the melody competition in Atlanta, and Blackbell are the current holders of the counter male voice choir Award, which was presented to them by the director of the London opera just last month. You can also be

a part of a recording deal. Mitchell's town has just joined Blackbell and Caroline singers as recording artists for their first CD do in shops in December. And if all of that isn't enough, you can also benefit the local community by helping to raise funds for good causes. mitchelstown regularly performs it functions helping the disabled and the elderly, while blackbelt donates a percentage of its profits to certain local charities.

1

Speaker 1

2:38

Before you hear the rest of the program, you have some time to look at questions 16 to 20 Now listen and answer questions 16 to 20.

2

Speaker 2

2:51

You may feel unable to join a choir because you're worried you'd struggle to find the time to attend rehearsals because of work or family commitments. Well, there is a solution to that. Start your own choir at work. This has been done in companies large and small. And I went to find out about the one at the accountants John White. The choirs organizer, elizabeth arnold told me the reason she thinks people like the choir. She said that while the thought of a big networking opportunities might be at the back of some people's mind. It's having the opportunity to switch off and focus on something completely different that they're after. The people that join tend to be fairly competent singers to start with, because naturally enough, people don't want to look bad in front of their colleagues. Companies like John White encourage their employees to set up choirs at work because it can help to create a healthier working atmosphere. For example, people who previously didn't get on can find they have something in common, which is just common sense really. elizabeth arnold also stresses that you don't need a lot of people to get the choir off the ground. They started off four years ago with just five people that's now risen to 19. While their average attendance at rehearsals is 12. Many people don't have time to go to rehearsals outside work. However they find the time to go to them while they're at work. At John White, they found the middle of the day works best because not everyone works the same hours. So scheduling early morning

rehearsals can be problematic. The same is true for late afternoon. supporting their choir is something that John White are very happy to do. Although members pay a joining fee to cover the cost of refreshments at parties and where's special concert shirts. The company organizes regular sessions with a professional vocal coach free of charge to members of the choir. So if you'd like more information about the choirs,

1

Speaker 1

5:13

that is the end of Section two, you now have half a minute to check your answers.